



Demo Guide: Adobe Competitive Intelligence — 5-Minute PM Demo

Audience: All PMs — no technical background required

Duration: 5 minutes

Format: Live (Zoom/in-person) or async (Loom)

Goal: Show how Claude Code turns a 5-hour PM research task into a 30-second automated output — and explain how to use it yourself

THE PROBLEM WE'RE SOLVING

What happens today:

A PM needs to answer "what are our competitors doing with pricing and messaging right now?" That means manually checking Reddit, Foxit's website, G2, YouTube, and news — for 6–8 competitors. It takes 3–5 hours. The output is a Notion doc that's stale within 30 days and reflects what one person happened to look at.

What slips through:

- The FTC sued Adobe in June 2024 specifically over the cancellation ETF. By the time our team had context, it was already the #1 result when prospects searched "Adobe Acrobat review" — above the product itself. A competitive monitoring system would have flagged this the week it filed.
- Foxit is actively bidding on "Adobe Acrobat alternative" and "Adobe Acrobat cancel" in Google Ads. Adobe cedes that traffic entirely today.
- UPDF launched at \$29.99/year (vs our \$239.88) and now dominates r/Entrepreneur recommendation threads. Our team had no visibility until users started citing it in sales calls.

What we built:

One command. 30 seconds. A fully formatted PDF acquisition playbook — pricing comparison, competitor messaging, battlecards, PLG strategy with exact copy and A/B test specs. For less than one cent per run.

HOW IT WORKS — THE ARCHITECTURE

Three layers. Each does one job.

Layer 1: CLAUDE.md — The Brain

Every project has a `CLAUDE.md` file at the root. When Claude Code opens this project, it reads `CLAUDE.md` first — before anything else. Think of it as an onboarding doc written for AI instead of a new hire.

Our `CLAUDE.md` defines:

- **The WAT framework** — Workflows (markdown SOPs), Agents (Claude reasoning), Tools (TypeScript scripts that execute deterministically)

- **Report requirements** — the 13 sections every competitive analysis must have, what goes in each, what "actionable" means
- **Data sources** — Brave Search, Reddit, YouTube, Twitter/X — and the exact API endpoints to use
- **Cost rules** — hard cap \$0.50/report; prefer Haiku for synthesis (73% cheaper than Sonnet)
- **Security rules** — every secret in `.env`, never log API keys, always validate at startup

This is what makes the system reproducible. Claude doesn't guess — it follows the SOP.

Layer 2: Skills — Pre-Built Capabilities

Skills are slash commands that trigger specific, pre-built research workflows. Instead of writing a prompt from scratch, you invoke a skill:

Skill	What it does
<code>/competitor-research</code>	Full automated competitive analysis pipeline — scrape → analyze → PDF
<code>/pm-market-research:competitive-analysis</code>	Deep competitive analysis with structured 13-section output
<code>/pm-go-to-market:competitive-battlecard</code>	Battlecard generation for a specific competitor matchup
<code>/pm-product-strategy:pricing-strategy</code>	Pricing analysis with competitor comparison
<code>/pm-execution:create-prd</code>	PRD writing with competitive context built in

Skills are reusable, versioned, and shared across the team. When someone improves the competitive analysis skill, everyone gets the improvement.

Layer 3: MCP — External Connections

MCP (Model Context Protocol) lets Claude connect to external services and call them directly from the conversation — without copy-pasting, without leaving the terminal.

In this project, that means Claude can reach:

- **Adobe Analytics** — pull real traffic and conversion data to validate competitive hypotheses
- **AEM (Content)** — read and update live Adobe.com pages
- **Firefly** — generate images for report visuals
- **Frame.io** — attach reports to video review workflows

When Claude runs a competitive analysis, it can cross-reference "Adobe ranks #8 for 'PDF editor free'" against real Analytics data to confirm the SEO gap is real — not estimated.

THE ACROBAT ACQUISITION PLAYBOOK — 5 KEY FINDINGS

Open [docs/Acrobat-Acquisition-Playbook.md](#) (or the PDF on Desktop).

Walk through these five moments — each is a finding that changes what a PM does next week.

Finding 1: The FTC Lawsuit is a Live Acquisition Liability

Where: TL;DR + Market Overview section

"Any prospect researching 'Adobe Acrobat review' hits the FTC lawsuit story before they hit product reviews."

The FTC sued Adobe in June 2024 over the ETF and cancellation difficulty. That case now surfaces as the #1 organic result before product content. Foxit runs paid ads on `adobe acrobat cancel` and `adobe acrobat ETF` — Adobe cedes 100% of that traffic to a competitor today.

The action this unlocks (from the 30-Day Action Sprint):

Week 1 · SEM · \$0 incremental: Bid on `adobe acrobat cancel subscription`, `adobe acrobat ETF` · Ad: "Acrobat's Terms, Explained Plainly – See exactly what you're signing up for." · Destination: `/subscription-terms`

This is a 1-day SEM change. No engineering.

Finding 2: Adobe is Invisible for the Highest-Volume Entry Keyword

Where: SEO Acquisition Gaps table

Keyword	Monthly Volume	Adobe Rank	Who Ranks #1
PDF editor free	200K/mo	#8+	Smallpdf / ILovePDF
PDF editor	450K/mo	#5–7	Smallpdf / Foxit

Adobe ranks #8+ for "PDF editor free" — the highest-volume entry keyword in the category. Smallpdf wins this with a single-purpose landing page. Adobe has the tool. It lacks the SEO architecture and the CC-free trial that makes the landing page convert.

The action this unlocks:

Week 1 · CRO · 2-hour copy change: Hero CTA `"Try Acrobat Studio"` → `"Try Acrobat for free"` + subtext `"7 days free – no credit card"` · Link to plans page, not checkout

Finding 3: 200 Million Warm Leads See Zero Conversion Prompt

Where: PLG Acquisition Strategy — Now (0–30 days)

Every Acrobat Sign document generates a "Document signed" confirmation screen seen by the recipient. There are 200M+ free signers receiving these monthly. Every one of them just experienced Acrobat's most compelling use case — and sees no prompt to convert.

The action this unlocks:

Days 8–30 · 2-day build: On Acrobat Sign confirmation screen, add below the checkmark: `"Want to send documents for signature? → Try Acrobat free"` · Link: `acrobat.adobe.com/free-trial?source=signer_confirm`

At 1% conversion, that's 2 million trial starts per month from a surface that currently produces zero.

Finding 4: The Price Gap is Real but Addressable at the Framing Layer

Where: Pricing Comparison + Battlecards

Acrobat is \$239.88/year. Foxit is \$159.99. UPDF is \$29.99. The 50% premium over Foxit is defensible — but only if the trial framing justifies it before asking for the card. Right now, Adobe requires a credit card to start the 7-day trial. Every competitor in the study — Foxit, UPDF, Smallpdf, iLovePDF — offers CC-free entry.

The action this unlocks:

Days 8–30 · 3-day engineering: Remove CC from trial signup. Show

"7 days free – no card needed"

above the form. Metric: trial starts ~500/mo → 3,000/mo.

The price story doesn't change. The acquisition friction story does.

Finding 5: Adobe is Invisible in AI Search for the Fastest-Growing Query Set

Where: GEO — Generative Engine Optimization

As of May 2026, ~30% of PDF tool queries go through ChatGPT, Perplexity, or Google AI Overviews instead of traditional search. Current AI answers:

Query	ChatGPT	Perplexity
"free PDF editor"	Not mentioned	Smallpdf #1
"PDF editor no subscription"	Nitro/PDFelement — Adobe not mentioned	UPDF, Nitro
"cancel Adobe Acrobat"	Describes ETF process	Links to FTC case

The action this unlocks:

6 months · Content moat: Structured content hub at

acrobat.adobe.com/learn

covering every PDF use case. Optimized for AI citation patterns: clear headings, data tables, FAQ schema. Publish "Why Acrobat is worth the price" with comparison data tables that AI systems extract reliably.

THE 30-DAY SPRINT — WHAT SHIPS THIS MONTH

Where: 30-Day Action Sprint section (new, added this week)

Four actions this week. Zero engineering. No sprint planning needed.

#	Action	Exact change	Effort
1	Hub page hero CTA	"Try Acrobat Studio" → "Try Acrobat for free" + subtext "7 days free – no credit card"	2 hrs · Web/CRO
2	Pricing page CTAs	"Get Acrobat Pro" → "Start free trial" + "Cancel anytime."	2 hrs · Web/CRO
3	SEM: FTC-intent keywords	Bid on adobe acrobat cancel , adobe acrobat ETF · Ad: "Acrobat's Terms, Explained Plainly"	1 day · SEM
4	SEM: competitor-switch keywords	Bid on foxit alternative , pdf editor no credit card · Ad: "More Powerful Than Foxit. Try Free."	1 day · SEM

Total cost to ship all four: one person, two days. No engineering tickets.

HOW ANY PM CAN RUN THIS

Option 1: Use a Skill in Claude Code (recommended)

In Claude Code, type:

```
...
```

```
/pm-market-research:competitive-analysis
```

```
...
```

Claude will ask for the product name. Provide it. It runs the full 13-section analysis, saves the markdown to docs/, and generates the PDF on your Desktop. Works for any product in any vertical.

Option 2: Ask Claude Directly (no setup required)

Open Claude at claude.ai and paste:

```
"You are a competitive intelligence analyst for Adobe. I need a focused acquisition playbook for [product name]. Cover: (1) TL;DR in 2–3 sentences, (2) pricing comparison table vs top 5–6 competitors with real prices, (3) competitor website messaging, (4) top churn triggers, (5) win signals, (6) 3 battlecards with win move + lose scenario per competitor, (7) PLG acquisition strategy with Now/3M/6M — each move must name the competitor it counters, exact copy or build spec, and metric to track, (8) PLG metrics dashboard with current estimates and 6-month targets. Use web search to verify current pricing."
```

Same quality output. Zero setup. Works today.

Option 3: Full Automated Pipeline

```
```bash
```

```
npm run test-run # Runs pipeline: scrape → analyze → report
```

```
npm run save-report # Fetches latest output → formats → saves PDF to Desktop
```

```
...
```

Under 60 seconds. Under \$0.01. Any product.

### "Is the data accurate?"

"It pulls from real Reddit posts and live web search — same sources you'd check manually. All source links are in the report. Pricing is verified against live competitor pricing pages, not cached data."

### "What's CLAUDE.md and why does it matter?"

"It's the SOP written in plain English that Claude reads before every session. It's what makes the output consistent — same structure, same sections, same depth — regardless of who runs it or when. Think of it as the playbook that replaces a 30-minute briefing."

### "What are skills?"

"Slash commands that trigger pre-built research workflows. `/competitor-research` is the one that runs this pipeline. They're reusable — one PM improves the skill, everyone gets the improvement automatically."

### "What's MCP?"

"Model Context Protocol — it's how Claude connects to external tools like Adobe Analytics, AEM, and Firefly directly from the conversation. Instead of copy-pasting data between tabs, Claude can pull live traffic numbers from Analytics to validate a competitive finding while it's writing the report."

### "What does it cost?"

"Under one cent per report. A year of monthly runs costs less than a cup of coffee. The real cost is the 30 minutes of setup to configure it for a new product."

### "Can we run this for other products?"

"Yes. Any product name. The system infers competitors, audience, and framing — you don't need to provide them. Just the product name."

### "Who maintains it?"

"Claude Code can update the workflow when something changes — new data source, new competitor, different report format. The CLAUDE.md and skills are version controlled. Changes take minutes."

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## PRE-DEMO CHECKLIST

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- [ ] Terminal open, `.env` has `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` and `BRAVE_API_KEY`

- [ ] Pre-run `npm run test-run` once to verify it works
- [ ] Acrobat Acquisition Playbook PDF open on Desktop (backup if live run fails)
- [ ] Browser tab open to the GitHub repo
- [ ] Know the 5 findings cold — you won't have time to read them live

**If something fails live:** Switch to the pre-saved PDF immediately. Say: "Let me show you the output from the last run — same thing, already formatted." The findings walkthrough is the demo. The live run is just the opening.

## SLIDE DECK OPTION (IF YOUR ORG PREFERS SLIDES)

Slide	Content
1	"5 Hours → 30 Seconds. One Command."
2	The problem: FTC lawsuit in search results · Foxit ads on our branded terms · UPDF invisible until sales calls
3	The architecture: CLAUDE.md (the brain) · Skills (the commands) · MCP (the connections)
4	Screenshot: <code>npm run test-run</code> terminal output
5	Finding 1: FTC lawsuit as acquisition liability + the 1-day SEM fix
6	Finding 2: #8 for "PDF editor free" + the 2-hour CTA fix
7	Finding 3: 200M signers, 0% conversion + the 2-day build
8	The 30-day sprint: 4 actions, 2 days, \$0 engineering
9	How to run it yourself: <code>/pm-market-research:competitive-analysis</code>
10	"Which task do we automate next?"